



2-D Studio Art 3 Honors

OPTIMA ACADEMY ONLINE · FAMILY COURSE OVERVIEW · GRADES 9–12 · FULL YEAR · 1 CREDIT · HONORS

~4¼ hrs per week · 50 min/day, M–F

About this overview. This document is an example of how the course might be taught. This page is drawn from the Florida course description rather than a built Optima course, so the specific artworks studied, projects, and activities will be set by the teacher and may vary between the live school and On-Demand. Each teacher also leans into their own strengths and passions; the structure, expectations, and time commitment below are representative of the course as designed.

2-D Studio Art 3 Honors is the year a scholar's work becomes a body of work. Scholars demonstrate proficiency in the conceptual development of content across drawing, painting, printmaking, collage, and design, creating self-directed or collaborative pieces suitable for a portfolio. Through focused investigation of traditional techniques, historical and cultural models, and individual expressive goals, scholars begin to develop a personal art style — with craftsmanship and quality of composition the standing expectations. As an honors course it carries genuine rigor: complex, multi-faceted projects, deeper analysis, and disciplined revision through critique.

THE YEAR AT A GLANCE

1 Self-Directed Studio Work (all year)

Portfolio-quality pieces made with conviction and disciplined craftsmanship, balancing spontaneity and purpose.

3 Series and Theme (all year)

Concentrating on a style, theme, or concept to develop artwork for a portfolio — including a series that speaks to personal opinions or current issues.

5 The Artist in the World (woven through)

Art's economic and community impact, art for causes, ethical appropriation, and coordinating a student or community art event.

2 Developing a Personal Style (all year)

Synthesizing established techniques, historical and cultural models, and the scholar's own expressive goals.

4 Critique (all year)

Constructive criticism as the engine of growth: assessing the challenges and outcomes of each medium in one's own work.

6 Portfolio and Exhibition (year-end)

Recording, curating, and presenting finished work digitally for display or exhibition.

A TYPICAL WEEK

- Optima art courses run on a two-week cycle, with honors scholars working at the self-directed end of it.
- Week 1: focused investigation — techniques, models, and concept development in the sketchbook.
- Week 2: produce and refine the finished piece, submitted with an artist statement — every finished work is signed.
- Critique is constant; portfolio curation builds toward exhibition.

On-Demand (asynchronous). Scholars move through the course at their own pace, with due dates to keep the year on track. An Optima teacher is available throughout for support, feedback, and grading.

TIME COMMITMENT

250 minutes / week

≈ 50 minutes a day, Monday–Friday

- Studio time fills most of the scheduled minutes, with honors projects often spanning multiple cycles.
- Portfolio and exhibition weeks close the year.

WHAT SCHOLARS NEED

- Art supplies for 2-D media: drawing, painting, printmaking, and collage materials as assigned by project.
- A computer with reliable internet and access to Canvas, plus a way to photograph finished work for submission.
- Microsoft 365 and OneDrive (provided to every scholar) for the portfolio.

Live school. Live-school scholars take this same course on Optima's VR campus with a teacher and classmates, meeting daily on the school's schedule.